The examination is being carried out on the **following application documents**

Description, Pages

1-152 as published

Claims, Numbers

1-15 filed in electronic form on 29-08-2022

Drawings, Sheets

1/63-63/63 as published

Reference is made to the following documents; the numbering will be adhered to in the rest of the procedure.

D1 US 2015/200969 A1 (LEUNG SIU-WANG [US] ET AL) 16 July 2015 (2015-07-16)

D2 EP 2 959 654 A1 (TOYOTA MOTOR CO LTD [JP]) 30 December 2015 (2015-12-30)

D3 US 2018/205703 A1 (GRAU ALAN [US]) 19 July 2018 (2018-07-19)

D4 FELSER MAX ET AL: "Coexistence Standardization of Operation Technology and Information Technology", PROCEEDINGS OF THE IEEE, IEEE. NEW YORK, US, vol. 107, no. 6, 1 June 2019 (2019-06-01), pages 962-976, XP011725969, ISSN: 0018-9219, DOI: 10.1109/JPROC.2019.2901314 [retrieved on 2019-05-29]

1 Claims dependent claims 11-14 do not fulfill the requirements of Article 123(2) EPC, for the following reasons:

New claim 11 is constituted by parts of original claim 24 and is made dependent on claim 1. It is not clear to the search division what the basis for the new combination of features should be in the original application. New claim 12 is dependent on new claim 11 and is constituted by the subject matter of original claim 25, which was dependent on original claim 25. It is not clear to the search division what the basis for the new combination of features should be in the original application. New claim 13 is based on old independent claim 40 and is made dependent on claim 1. There is not basis in the application as filed for this

new combination of subject matter. New claim 14 is based on parts of original claim 41 and dependent on claim 13 (and indirectly claim 1). It is not clear to the search division what the basis for the new combination of features should be in the original application.

2 Claim 12 is unclear and does therefore not fulfill the requirements of Article 84 EPC, for the following reasons: it is stated that "the network regulation description comprises a data request permission description comprising data values associated with data requestors, wherein at least a portion of the data requestors comprise end points of at least one of the first network zone or the second network zone, and wherein the first network interface circuit is further structured to regulate communications in response to the data request permission description."

Upon reading the description it seems as if data value has the meaning of the value of some parameter, for instance a measurement value from a sensor. It is not clear to the examining division how sensor values are to be used for deciding if a requestor is to be given access to these values (at least not in the context of the application).

3 With regard to present claim 1 the document D1 discloses A system, comprising:
~~a vehicle having~~ at least one network zone (paragraph 0020);
a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy (paragraph 0021) comprising a local domain name server (DNS) (paragraph 0040) , an authorization description (paragraph 0033), and a firewall configuration description (paragraph 0021);
~~a configuration circuit structured to configure a gatekeeper interface circuit in response to the policy~~; and
a ~~gatekeeper interface~~ circuit interposed between the at least one network zone and an external communication portal selectively couplable to an external device, and further structured to regulate communications between end points of the at least one network zone and the external communication portal (paragraph 0003).

Hence the difference between the system of claim 1 and that disclosed by D1 is that in the former:

The system is implemented in a vehicle;

A gatekeeper circuit is used to implement the functionality of the system of D1.

Regarding the second difference it is not clear what the technical significance of using a gatekeeper instead of a gateway as is disclosed in paragraph 0002 of D1 or if it is just a renaming matter.

The objective problem to be solved is therefore how to extend the functionality of a system according to D1 for use in further entities.

The solution according to claim 1 is to implement it in a vehicle, this solution is known from paragraph 0002-0004 of D2.

Hence claim 1 does not fulfill the requirements of Article 56 EPC, due to a lack of inventive step.

4 The additional subject matter of claims 2 and 3 is constituted by the use of local or global addresses in the DNS for the network zone. This is a well known address resolution scheme that does not give any contribution to an inventive step. The additional subject matter of claims 4, 5 and 10 are example of the use of bandwidth limitation and quality of service requirements without any further details regard how they are used or constituted. Such use is well known in the area and does not give any contribution to an inventive step. The additional subject matter of claims 6-9 are only standard descriptions used for configuring a firewall and does therefore not give any contribution to an inventive step. The additional subject matter of claim 11 is known from paragraph 0008 of D2. The additional subject matter of claim 12 does not seem to have any technical effect (see also point 2 above regarding clarity) and can therefore not contribute to an inventive step. The additional subject matter of claim 13 is known from or at least rendered obvious by paragraph 0009 of D2. The additional subject matter of claim 14 (the policy further comprises an external data access description) is only a definition of how to regulate access from external devices, this is a well known part of any firewall and does therefore not contribute to an inventive step. The additional subject matter of claim 15 only defines the well known concept of hierarchical rules (a way to avoid rule collisions) and does therefore not contribute to an inventive step.

Hence claims 2-15 do not fulfill the requirements of Article 56 EPC, due to a lack of inventive step.

5 The independent claims are not in the two-part form, which in the present case would be appropriate, with those features known from the prior art being placed in the preamble and with the remaining features being included in the characterising part (Rule 43(b) EPC).

6 To meet the requirements of Rule 42(b) EPC, the documents D1-D4 should have been identified in the description and the relevant background art disclosed therein should have been briefly discussed.

7 The features of the claims should have been provided with reference signs placed in parentheses to increase the intelligibility of the claims (Rule 43(7) EPC). This applies to both the preamble and characterising portion.

8 When filing amended claims the applicant should at the same time bring the description into conformity with the amended claims. Care should be taken during revision, especially of the introductory portion and any statements of problem or advantage, not to add subject-matter which extends beyond the content of the application as originally filed (Article 123(2) EPC).

9 In order to facilitate the examination of the conformity of the amended application with the requirements of Article 123(2) EPC, the applicant is requested to clearly identify the amendments carried out, irrespective of whether they concern amendments by addition, replacement or deletion, and to indicate the passages of the application as filed on which these amendments are based.